

Real-time voting: Content Design Strategy & Spec - **WIP**

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Status: **In Progress**

Relevant Docs:

Summary:

Live Interactive Moments (LIMs) allow members to interact directly with, and impact, live broadcasts in real-time. While we've set up a broad framework to support a variety of different LIMs and will reuse strings that are scalable across LIM types, the real-time voting MVP experience is the primary use case covered within this content spec.

Content Strategy:

While content design will leverage the overall Live and Netflix strategy and style, there are unique considerations for our real-time voting MVP (Star Search) and LIMs more generally. These messaging-heavy experiences benefit from lean-forward, live-edge viewing and language that promotes anticipation and clear understanding.

Value Props: Impactful, innovatively easy, fair and balanced, communal

Challenges: distractions, screen blindness, misinterpretation, lean-back viewing

LIM Content Opportunities and Guidelines

- **Balanced integration**
 - LIMs are inherently intertwined with content, so there may be opportunities for shared language from the source content, as well as opportunities to flex voice and tone to align with the show and create a more cohesive feeling experience.
 - At the same time, we want to avoid members confusing our LIM UI for the production, pop-up ads, or any other surfaces that aren't LIM-related.
- **Show *and* tell**
 - We'll lean on audio and visual cues, evidence and the production of the show to help educate members. While there will be content throughout the LIM Lifecycle, there's limited time and space for in-depth instruction, so pairing with other signals is important.
- **Live First**
 - The pairing of Voting + TV has existed for a long time, so it's important to help users understand and get the most of LIMs by promoting and enabling live-edge viewing, and the uniqueness of the experience where possible.

- **Start to finish**
 - Maintain content through-lines for clarity (Open/Closed, Start/Stopped, Begin/End, etc.).
- **Dedupe**
 - Copy and UI elements can do multiple jobs, allowing us to eliminate unnecessary duplicative messaging (ex: “Vote Now” with an animated countdown may accomplish the same as several messages “Voting is Open > Vote Now > Voting is Closing > Voting is Closed”).
 - Animation, sound and in-show production can also stand in for or back up messaging touchpoints.
- **Direct and concise**
 - Speaking directly to what’s happening, whether picking up your remote, or rating a specific performer, is crucial to people’s engagement and interaction.
 - Shorter strings will work better within the LIM MVP as we’re limited in UI space. We also know some UI windows are short, so on-screen copy needs to be visible and easily understood on first read through.
- **Keep it fresh**
 - Live Interactive Moments may be repeated many times throughout a program, so we can use randomized language variants to help keep the experience fresh and delightful.

Terminology and product usage

Real-time voting

“Real-time _____” or “real-time voting” will be used as common, descriptive language, not as branded terminology. Capitalization is dependent on the canvas and string type, and while it will be unlikely to show up in title case on-product, generally we would follow these CD guidelines:

Do use title case in:	Don’t use title case in:
● Badges ● Buttons (CTAs) ● Standalone text links, known as tertiary buttons. ● Nav labels ● Metadata tags ● Menus ● Row names ● Supplemental messages ● Table and column headers (mainly in Studio) ● Titles (page titles, section titles)	● Body copy ● Eyebrows ● Form-field labels ● Headlines (page headlines, section headlines, component headlines) ● Subheads ● Text links when part of a sentence. ● URLs, URL paths

UI Element Names	
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In addition, we have these guidelines specifically for using real-time ____ in member-facing product language:

- Real-time should be hyphenated when written in American English and modifying an interaction type. It may be written without hyphen when localized into other English languages if appropriate, or written as a noun. Per AP style: "Real-time" is hyphenated when used as an adjective before a noun, and "real time" is used as a noun or adverb.

Discovery, evidence, callouts

- Our current hypothesis is that Callouts provide the best surface for member-facing feature education within the browse experience.
 - Live callouts will be moved to the “availability bar,” leaving more room and visibility for a callout.
 - Synopsis were largely overlooked in Quals and will already have localization info built in.
 - CTAs will have Ads Support messaging.

Voice and Tone



Helpful

Always keep a helping hand extended to make Netflix feel easy and intuitive.



Warm

We're happy our members choose us. Write in a way that says we're glad they're here.



Anticipatory

Whether it's the next episode, plot twist or innovation, we're as excited for what comes next as our members.



Playful

If you're not having fun writing it, people probably won't have fun reading it. Keep it light.



Unexpected

Condition people to expect to be pleasantly surprised with Netflix.

We'll lean on Helpful and Anticipatory messaging within the Live Interactive Moment lifecycle, ensuring members understand when and how to interact. Occasionally, we can turn up our Warm and Playful tones to match the tone of the show, and emphasize light celebratory moments, like at confirmation a vote has been received, or during payoff.

Lead-in	Open	Interaction	Crescendo	Confirmation	Close	Payoff
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- Anticipatory
 - Helpful
- Helpful
- Anticipatory
 - Helpful
- Warm
 - Playful
 - Anticipatory
- Helpful
 - Playful

UI Lifecycle and Messaging Touchpoints

These are the core messaging opportunities from an end-to-end LIM. The phases of this lifecycle are

Lead-in	Interactive Window					Payoff
	Open	Interaction	Crescendo	Confirmation	Close	
• Context and Anticipatory mentions • “Grab your remote!” style messaging	• Interactive UI appears • “Voting is now open.” or “Vote now” type messaging • Unsupported scenario messages	• Timed interaction period • Different interactions possible here	• Ending-soon messaging, animation or other signal • Timer UI updates to signal urgency	• Confirming the interaction is complete • TV only: whatever is in focus is selected • “Your vote was cast!”	• Interaction time ends • “Voting is closed.”	• Results shown

	Function	Custom/One-Time Treatment	Scalable/Reusable Treatment	In-Producti on/ Voice Over Opportunity
Before Vote	Pre-Vote Countdown		• Voting Opens in <countdown> • Voting Starts in <countdown>	

		Voting Begins in <countdown>	
	Instruction/Education		✓
During Vote	Voting Open	- Voting is Now Open - Vote Now - Voting Has Started - Time to Vote	✓
	Voting header/CTA	- Rate <contestant name> from N to N - Vote for <contestant name> - Give <contestant name> a score - Who's your favorite?	- Vote Now - Cast your vote! - Rate <contestant name> - Score the contestants
	Voting Countdown	- Voting ends in <countdown> - Voting closes in <countdown> - No copy <Countdown>	
	Voting Mechanism	★★★★★	Button list with custom text/icons
	Submission CTAs		- Submit - Vote Now - Vote
	Vote Confirmation	*Visual Treatment*	- Vote Submitted - Your Vote Was Counted - Vote Counted - Voted
	Head to Head		
After Vote	Voting Closed/Over While Live	- Voting is Now Closed - Voting is Closed - Voting Has Ended - Voting is Over - Voting Has Stopped	✓
	Post-Play, Voting Closed (DVR/SVOD)	- Voting Has Ended - Voting is Over	✓

Errors, Edgcases and Other Messages

Behind Live Edge

- Voting isn't supported on your device. Scan the code or go to <url> to vote now.
- Voting isn't supported on your device. Go to <Show> on your phone to vote now.

- Voting has started. Watch Live to join the vote.

**Already Voted
(Device Jumping)**

Vote doesn't go through

Pause During Vote

Picture-in-Picture

Landing in the middle of a vote

**Miss the first vote,
can you vote for
the next?**

**Interaction
T&Cs/Consent**

Edgescases Messaging:

[illegible]

	Browse	Waiting Room	Join Playback	LIM Lead-In	LIM Reveal	LIM Interaction	LIM Crescendo	LIM Confirm	LIM Close
Behind Live Edge (Pause, Rewind, Bookmark)	Should we default to live edge from CW?	N/A	IMS: Message user they're behind the live edge	TBD: Jump to Live Edge message	No message	No message	No message	No message	No message
DVR	☒ Already supported Leave callout	N/A	Message user the program is no longer live	No message	No message	No message	No message	No message	No message
SVOD	☒ Already supported Leave callout	N/A	No message (baked into video)	No message (baked into video)	No message (baked into video)	No message (baked into video)	No message (baked into video)	No message (baked into video)	No message (baked into video)
Voting Unsupported (tvOS, web, mobile client on older version)	Hide callouts for Real-Time Voting?	Waiting room: How to + Device support messaging	IMS: Message the user their device is not supported	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
During Live, Already Voted	☒ Already supported	N/A	N/A						

Error framework:

We want to be granular enough to provide members a different message and solution depending on the reason they're running into trouble:

- You're behind the live edge, jump to live to vote.
- You're on an unsupported device, go to help article to see a list of supported devices.
- You're

CD Spec - Drop 1

Early framework:

We want to be granular enough to provide members a different message and solution depending on the reason they're running into trouble or in a state we don't want them in (behind the live edge):

- You're behind the live edge > jump to live to vote.
- You're on an unsupported device > go to help article to see a list of supported devices.
- You're watching a previously live event > reminder to watch live at air time.

Ad in logic for timing and overlapping messages

Behind the live edge messages:

Playback > Ads Interstitial > T&Cs > Ratings > Behind Live Edge message >

Unsupported messages:

Playback > Ads Interstitial > Rating > Unsupported Message

DVR messages:

Playback > Rating > Previously Live/Watch Live Message

SVOD:

Playback > Rating > Previously Live/Watch Live Message

DVR on Unsupported

Watch live on a supported device to vote. Learn More at <URL>

SVOD on Unsupported

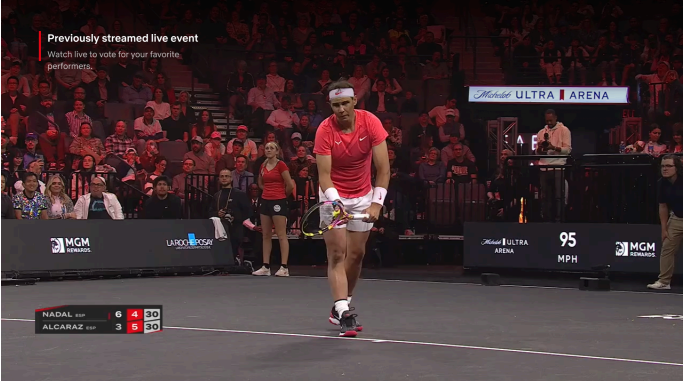
Watch live on a supported device to vote. Learn More at <URL>

Ads Logic

1. The overlay has a time based and profile based frequency cap:
 - a. Time Based:
 - i. Maximum of 1 interstitial per 24 hours
 1. Also can be defined on different "sessions" which are being investigated by eng such as Binge Session [TBD] and App Session [TBD]
 - ii. This satisfies the main NFL requirement which is to only show the overlay once and not a second time when the 2nd game starts.
 - b. Profile Based:
 - i. Maximum of 3 interstitials for 1 profile ever, and it never resets to prevent overexposure in the long term.
 1. This will be tested into with the NFL meaning that if there is little to

no member reaction, we will keep showing it. If there is a strong reaction, we will not keep showing it.

TV -		
Context	Design	Content
Behind Live Edge - Prompt		[toast] You have to be watching live in order to vote. [cta] Jump to Live [cta alt] Watch Live [Warm alt] [toast] Make sure you're watching live to vote. [cta] Watch Live [generic alt] [toast] You're missing the live action! [cta] Jump to Live [cta] Jump to Vote
Unsupported device - IMS supported		[TV-specific] [Header] Real-time voting isn't supported on this TV. Learn more at <url> [cta] Got It [Device Generic] [Header] Watch live on a supported device to vote. Learn more at <url> [cta] Got It
Unsupported device - IMS unsupported		TBD
SVOD		

DVR -		[hijacked rating] [header] Previously streamed live [body] Watch live to vote for your favorite performances. [DOW version] [header] Previously streamed live [body] Watch live Monday, Wednesday and Friday to rate your favorite performances.
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Mobile -		
Context	Design	Content
Behind Live Edge - Prompt		[toast] Make sure to watch live in order to vote. [cta] Jump to Live [cta alt] Watch Live
Unsupported device - IMS Interstitial		[Header] Voting isn't supported on this device. <Learn More>
Unsupported device - no IMS available		[toast] Voting isn't supported on this device.<Learn More>
SVOD		
DVR -		[header] Previously streamed live event [body] Watch live to vote for your favorite performances.